

WD Scorpio Blue 1TB

Western digital has launched a 1 TB iteration of its value Scorpion Blue. Coming in a 2.5-inch form factor with 5400 RPM and 8MB buffer

Google buys PittPatt

Google recently acquired PittPatt, a company that specializes in facial recognition in still photos and videos

USB 2.0 DRIVES

Verbatim sent us their 500GB external drive which features an eSATA port alongwith a USB 2.0 port. The eSATA port gave impressive speeds as expected. But 500 GB with an external power supply seems a bit much.

Seagate sent us three drives: GoFlex Home (1TB), GoFlex Desk (2TB) and GoFlex Pro (500GB). Both the GoFlex Home and GoFlex Pro drives have a similar form factor, but the Pro has a 7200 RPM drive inside it, coming with two connector option. One is the proprietary Seagate connector which allows these drives to be USB 3.0 upgradeable and the other is a stand which has the male joint which fits in the groove of the Seagate drive's base. This of course comes at a premium. The GoFlex Home is the drive which requires an external power supply. It has a sturdy build and comes with a stand to mount the hard drive on.

Western Digital had the My Passport for Mac and My Passport Studio, both 500 GB. My Passport for Mac has a matte black finish and is Time Machine ready. We tested it on the same testbed as the others, as we were primarily interested in the transfer speeds. The My Passport Studio looks interesting thanks to the e-ink display it has on which gives a

memory status bar and allows you to name the hard drive which is visible even on disconnecting the drive. Along with the USB 2.0 interface it also has a FireWire 800 support.

Transcend StoreJet 1 TB drive has a rubberised finish which makes the drive bulky but quite rugged. It has protection from all three sides. Like the ADATA Nobility NH03, the StoreJet also has a one button backup option. Iomega eGo desktop drive was one with a power supply.



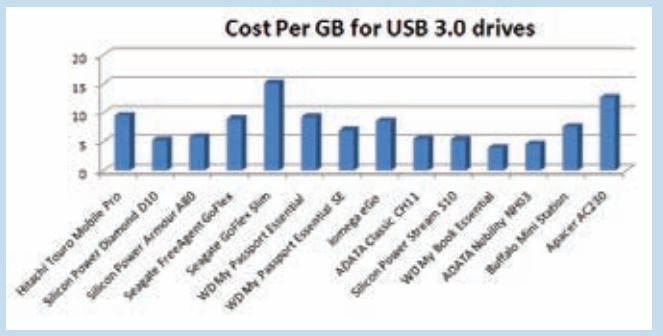
ADATA Nobility
NH03

It comes with a stand and is quite bulky in appearance. It also comes with an online backup utility. Buffalo Drive Station is a comparatively less bulky drive and has a lovely black glossy finish. When using TurboCopy here, we did get impressive improvement in data transfer speeds. It comes bundled with all the utilities seen in the Buffalo Mini Station.

Apacer AC203 looks aesthetically very similar to its USB 3.0 cousin - AC230.

COST PER GIGABYTE

The cost per gigabyte for USB 3.0 drives is not drastically high when compared with the USB 2.0 counterparts. In fact WD My Book Essential 3 TB drive has a cost/GB of ₹3.9 which is just 20 paise higher than the cheapest cost/GB found on the Buffalo Drive station in the USB 2.0 drives category.



ADATA Nobility NH92 has a shiny blue plastic finish with the mini-USB port lodged at one edge. A blue light glows at the other edge when the drive is in operation. It comes with a backup as well as an encryption utility.

drive transfers in the USB 2.0 drives is painfully slow. Seagate GoFlex Pro and Transcend StoreJet were portable drives that gave impressive overall speeds across various test scenarios.

Winners

Drives requiring an external power supply: There were only six drives in this category. ADATA Nobility NH03 won the Best Performer for its high scores across most of the benchmarks. It touched as high as 120MB/s in the Read tests. Best Buy in this segment went to the maximum capacity drive i.e. the WD My Book Essential 3 TB. Not only did this drive give a lower cost per GB at ₹3.9 but it also performed 90 per cent as well as the Best Performer. You can find the table online: http://bit.ly/digit_HDD

Portable Drives under than or equal to 750GB: Silicon Power Diamond D10 drive was awarded as the Best Buy. It was competing against its own cousins the

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